N E W S L E T T E R

Congregation Tifereth Israel
Sephardic

VOLUME 56 NO. 1 JANUARY, 2026

Tu B'Shvat is the Jewish holiday occurring on the 15th day of the Hebrew month of Shevat, Monday, February 2nd. It is also called "Jewish Arbor Day", or "New Year of the Trees." In contemporary Israel, the day is celebrated as an ecological awareness day, and trees are planted in celebration. It is also observed by eating fruits and honoring our connection to and dependence on the world around us as we celebrate the environment and G-d's beautiful natural world.

IMPORTANT ANNOUNCEMENT:

In April, we will be holding elections for officers and board members to lead Congregation Tifereth Israel for the next two years. Jay Polonsky is chairman of the Nominating Committee and welcomes your input. If you would like to be a part of the executive board, please submit your name to: info@ctipeabody.org, no later than January 11, 2026. The proposed slate of officers as determined by the Nominating Committee, consisting of four members of the Board of Directors and three individuals from the general membership of the Congregation, will be printed in the March *Newsletter*.

From the President...

Let me start by wishing everyone a happy, healthy and prosperous New Year. Election of officers and directors for the next two years will be taking place at the April congregation meeting. Please plan on attending and register your pleasure or displeasure with the way things are being run.

As you are all aware there has been an increase both locally and internationally of Anti-Semitism, as well as mass shootings. The time has come that we can no longer remain silent in the hope that someone else will speak up. We all need to contact our local, state, and federal law makers, to speak on our behalf to end this spiraling problem. We all have friends that are of different faiths than us and should encourage them to speak to their religious leaders. If everyone does their part then hopefully we can put and end to this and live as brothers and sisters in peace.

Shalom,
Jerry Pressman, President

From the Ladies Auxiliary President...

Hello Ladies,

Happy 2026! I hope everyone enjoyed the holidays! At our Ladies' Auxiliary meeting held on November 19th, we voted to hold elections in the Spring. Anyone interested in running should contact me through the synagogue's email: ladies-auxiliary@ctipeabody.org.

I want to remind everyone if you haven't already paid your dues, please contact Millie Becker.

Our book club is currently reading, "The Thread Collectors" by Shauna J. Edwards and Alyson Richman and will meet on Zoom on Monday, January 5th at 7:30 PM. The book club is open to everyone, so please feel free to join us!

Stay warm!

Fran Arsenault-Shaheen,
President, Ladies Auxiliary

Thank you to the following members and friends who have made donations to CTI in memory of their loved ones whose Meldathos were observed during recent Shabbat services and others who have recently passed on:

Donated by	In Memory Of
Barry & Kathy Blair	Max Blair - Father
Diane Elefson	Barbara Adams - Sister
Cynthia Garber	Aaron Garber - Husband
Lorna Goldberg	Fannie Hasday - Grandmother
Lorna Goldberg	Robert Hasday - Grandfather
Doris Hershoff	Jack Yonis - Brother
David & Lily Podradchik	Ralph Polonsky - Grandfather
Betty & Jay Polonsky	Ralph Polonsky - Father
Betty & Jay Polonsky	Joseph Polonsky - Grandfather
Joanne & Jerry Pressman	Emili Pernitchi - Grandmother
Adele Shackelford	Robert Pollock - Husband
Adele Shackelford	Libby Gans - Sister
Adele Shackelford	William Barber - Grandfather
Adele Shackelford	Michael Lanes - Grandfather
Adele Shackelford	Lynn Shackelford - Husband
Fran & John Shaheen	Robert M. Hasday - Brother
Marcia Smokler	Robert Yudin - Beloved Brother
Patricia & Harry Stewart	Max Blair - Father

Thank you to the following members and friends who have made donations to CTI for the following:

Donated by	In Honor of
Jill & Steve Pressman, Samantha & Sarah Kraus	Joanne & Jerry Pressman our Parents/Grandparents

Thank you to the following members and friends who have made donations to the **Happy Day Fund** of the Ladies Auxiliary:

To - Occasion	Donated by
Betty Polonsky - in honor of her 70th birthday	Doris Hershoff
Julie Barth - in memory of her Mother Phyllis Blumsack	Joanne & Jerry Pressman
Steven Linsky - for a speedy recovery	Joanne & Jerry Pressman

YOU CAN HELP

Would you like to learn the Sephardic High Holiday melodies and participate more fully in the services? Joanne Pressman is trying to arrange a choir of our members to rehearse over the summer months and assist in leading the Congregation in the traditional prayers of our ancestors. If you are interested, respond by email to: info@ctipeabody.org. Please consider joining in this important endeavor!

THANK YOU

To Diane and Harvey Elefson who designated CTI as the recipient of a generous donation resulting from their volunteer hours working the B'nai B'rith booth at the Topsfield Fair.

To Joanne and Jerry Pressman for sponsoring our October Oneg Shabbat; and to Leslie Emack and Barry Lichinsky for sponsoring our November Oneg Shabbat.

To David Podradchik for his amazing job of cleaning and polishing the silver crowns and breastplate to restore their beauty when they adorn our Torahs.

CONGRATULATIONS & MAZEL TOV

To members Ian Freedman and Rachel Hans on their recent wedding, and to their parents Heidi August and Louis Freedman, and Dora and Andrew Hans.

GET WELL WISHES

Heidi August, Millie Becker, Donna Bean Berman, Nancy Duerr, Andrew Elefson, Barbara Forbes, Robert Furtado, Cynthia Garber, Judi Gitter, Carole Hanak, Ron Hanak, Ellen Jagher, Steven Linsky, Ilene Garber MacDonald, Mary Jo Petrone, Paula Podradchik, Ryan Podradchik, Jay Polonsky, Jerry Pressman, Joanne Pressman, Jack Romo, Sheila Romo, Ann Segal, Gloria Sontz, Harvey Tanzer, Beth Thibault, Aaron Thompson, and Linda Weaver.

REMINDER

If you would like to send a card offering condolences or well wishes to someone, consider making a donation to our Happy Day Fund. Contact Wendy Tirck at 978-750-4063 or email **wtirck@icloud.com**. She will send a CTI card for a $5.00 donation to the **Happy Day Fund**.

FRIDAY EVENING SERVICE DATES

Shevat - January 23	Adar - February 20
Nisan - March 20	Iyar - April 24
Sivan - May 22	Tamuz - June 19
Av - July 17	Elul - August 14

All services begin at 7:30 P. M. and include the reading of the Yahrzeit memorial names for that Hebrew month.

YAHRZEIT - MELDATHOS

JANUARY		SHEVAT
Services Friday, Jan. 23, 7:30 PM		
19	Lloyd Silverman	1
19	Rose Hasday	1
19	Nelson Gediman	1
20	Joseph Havian	2
20	Ruth Parkin-Goodman	2
21	Alice Stein	3
21	Joseph Pernitchi	3
22	Samuel Stein	4
26	Victoria Eskenas	8
26	E. Judith Castiglione	8
29	Joshua Eskenazi	11
29	Tillie Polonsky	11
FEBRUARY		
3	Robert Furtado	16
4	Albert Gibeley	17
4	Sadie Behar	17
6	Solomon Levy	19
7	Robert Weaver	20
8	Maya Seriy	21
12	Mary Menovich	25
12	Charlotte Harsfield	25
12	Jack Gibely	25
14	Sara Bengar	27
17	Joshua Yonis	30

FEBRUARY		ADAR
Services Friday, Feb. 20, 7:30 PM		
18	Donna Behar	1
18	Ida Elefson	1
18	Rose Melamed Kagan	1
19	Sidney Sands	2
20	Samuel Gitter	3
22	Harold Jagher	5
22	Nathan Kropp	5
23	Bernice Edelstein	6
25	E. Judith Castiglione	8
26	Thelma Kropp	9
27	Matilda Barber	10
27	Shirley Shapiro	10
27	Sara Yonis	10
28	Evelyn Menovich	11
28	Robert Y. Gibeley	11
MARCH		
1	Theodore Linsky	12
2	Saul Prager	13
3	Rita Datz	14
5	Dwayne Emack	16
7	Alice Gibeley	18
7	Mary Sumberg	18
7	Regina Louriero	18
8	Florence Silverman	19
10	Charles Segal	21
10	Maya Seriy	21
12	Sarah Gibely	23
12	Asa Polonsky	23
13	Steven Rosenberg	24
14	Leonard Elefson	25
16	Izzy Havian	27
18	Heidi Sue Gitter	29
18	Rose Romo	29

BIRTHDAYS

JANUARY		FEBRUARY	
1	Joel Havian	1	Ian Freedman
3	Jerry Pressman	1	Arnold Gitter
4	Erin Arsenault	5	Danica Jane Guidice
4	Stephanie Fain	6	Craig Podradchik
4	Jonathan Jagher	7	Max Feldman
4	Mae Simone Jagher	7	Mark Linsky
7	Francine Black	7	Janet Kramer
9	Elizabeth Thibault	8	Jay Polonsky
12	Gary Arsenault	9	Leo Feldman
13	Steven Linsky	10	Jonathan Stewart
16	Rebecca Havian	12	Michael Gitter
17	Christine Jagher	12	Ayla Goldberg
17	Sandra Jagher	13	Emerson Frasch
17	Gloria Sontz	13	Oliver Frasch
20	Derek Cohen	18	David Podradchik
21	Eric Black	19	Michael Becker
24	Stephanie Linsky	24	Jayden Polonsky
27	Scarlet Rose Ellis	26	Ian Paul Gleich
27	Howard Olsher	26	Jill Pressman
28	Edward Garber	27	Joanne Pressman
29	Howard Kosovske	27	Cecile Rowen
30	Maya Arsenault	27	Idina Podradchik
31	Doris Hershoff		

ANNIVERSARIES

JANUARY		FEBRUARY	
13	Mr. & Mrs. Joel Shenker	4	Mr. & Mrs. Jerry Pressman

CANDLE LIGHTING TIMES FOR SHABBAT:

January 2	4:05	February 6	4:47
January 9	4:12	February 13	4:56
January 16	4:20	February 20	5:05
January 23	4:29	February 27	5:14
January 30	4:38		